

Prescription drug tiers (cont.)

- **Preferred drugs** are FDA approved prescription medications included on the Preferred Drug List developed by CVS Caremark. This list is developed by an independent panel of doctors and pharmacists who ensure the medications are clinically appropriate and cost-effective.
- **Non-Preferred drugs** are FDA approved prescription medications that may or may not be covered by G.E.H.A, however they are not included on the CVS Caremark Preferred Drug List. Most commonly utilized medications have generic or preferred medications available.

High Option Maintenance Choice

Maintenance Choice® lets you choose how to get 90-day supplies of your maintenance medications: through mail service or at a retail CVS Pharmacy. Either way, you pay mail service prices for 90-day supplies. After two retail 30-day prescription fills, members are required to use their mail service benefit. With the Maintenance Choice program, members can continue to use retail CVS Pharmacy locations to gain access to a 90-day supply while accessing the mail order coinsurance under your plan. Maintenance Choice also allows members the ability to have their prescription transferred from the mail order service to a retail CVS Pharmacy location if the member wants the experience of talking with pharmacy staff in person. If a member would like to get started with mail service for the first time, they can call the CVS Caremark Fast Start program and CVS Caremark will work with their physician to acquire a 90-day supply prescription to be filled through either the CVS Caremark Mail Service Pharmacy or their local retail CVS Pharmacy. The CVS Caremark Fast Start program can be reached at 800-875-0867 or members can sign in or register at geha.com/Prescriptions-Summary once their plan year begins.

CVS Caremark Formulary

Your prescription drug program includes use of the CVS Caremark Formulary which is developed by an independent panel of doctors and pharmacists who ensure the medications are clinically appropriate and cost-effective. Formularies are reviewed quarterly; medications may change formulary status. You will receive notification if your cost share increases due to a formulary change. In an effort to continue to help promote affordable and clinically appropriate products, there are a select number of drugs that are excluded from the formulary and not covered by the Plan. For these drugs, generics and/or therapeutic alternative medications in the same drug class are readily available. If one of these excluded drugs is medically necessary, a **preauthorization for medical necessity is required**. We do not cover excluded drugs unless we determine the medical necessity to treat a medical condition based on objective clinical data. New drugs and supplies may be added to the list as they are introduced and may require medical necessity review until the formulary status is determined. Please visit our website at geha.com/Prescriptions-Summary to view formulary medications and the most current list of specialty drugs. You may call CVS Caremark at 844-443-4279 or CVS Specialty at 800-237-2767 for specialty medications.

Our benefit includes the Advanced Control Specialty Formulary (ACSF). The ACSF may reduce your out-of-pocket costs yet may limit your options due to a strict formulary. The ACSF focuses on specialty medications that are very similar to one another, with similar effectiveness and safety. The formulary incorporates step therapy, where a generic/preferred medication is used prior to a brand and/or non-preferred medication. The ACSF is reviewed quarterly, and medications may change formulary status. Impacted members will be notified of the change at least 60 days in advance. If the formulary change will lower your cost share for the medication(s), you have the option to speak with your doctor about a prescription for the lower cost alternative. Please visit our website at geha.com/Prescriptions-Summary to view the most current list of specialty drugs. You may also call CVS Specialty at 800-237-2767.

Notes:

- **Changes to the formulary are not considered benefit changes.**
- Your physician may be contacted to discuss your prescriptions for drugs that are excluded by the Plan's formulary. No change in the medication prescribed will be made without your physician's approval.
- **Any rebates or savings received by the Plan on the cost of drugs purchased under this Plan from drug manufacturers are credited to the health plan and are used to reduce healthcare costs.**